



ASUS introduces P7P55D series motherboards for the Core i5 and i7 processors



ASUS launches the SV1T skype videophone with wi-fi and a touchscreen

Samsung Jet

A multimedia powerhouse

The Jet is Samsung's attempt at enticing people enthused about getting a multimedia touch phone. At first sight, the Jet looks very cool in its black avatar and holographic back panel. Its shape and size make it quite comfortable to hold as well as to slip into the pocket. Unlike many metal-bodied Samsung phones, this one does not give that feel of toughness; it feels somewhat delicate. The phone has a vibrant 3.1-inch AMOLED display. The pixel-packed 480 x 800 pixel resolution makes the content played on it look crisp. Although the display is of resistive nature, the OS is optimized to be used entirely by fingers. There's no stylus provided with the package. The display's vibrance suffers under direct sunlight; you can just about read the text on the screen. The front bears call answer/end keys and an odd hexagonal three-way button. It oddly does not help navigate through menus but rather, it is used to switch between running applications. The buttons on the phone are tactile. The phone gives a vibrating feedback to every press registered on the display.

The phone runs Samsung's proprietary TouchWiz 2.0 OS. Its interface design is quite attractive. The interface performs flawlessly thanks to the Jet's fast processor. The home screen bears many pre-installed widgets like world clock, calendar, Facebook etc. that can be customised further. Multiple widgets can be placed across three home screen windows. The Internet browser renders full-blown websites quite nicely. The browser gets sluggish at times lag at times depending on the site you visit. There isn't a cut-copy-paste functionality. The high resolution screen can be disadvantageous at



times. For example, while using Google Maps, the text appeared very small. The touch interfacing system works well and has fewer hits-and-misses than other touch devices. The phone is quite narrow, so Samsung chose to fit a full QWERTY keyboard only in landscape mode. It takes time to get typing quickly and accurately on it. There's also handwriting recognition, but we doubt anybody would want to use their fingernails to scribble characters. At the end of the day, the Samsung Jet is not a smartphone. Installing applications is only limited to Java applications. People who would like to extend the functionality of their phone by installing a lot of third-party programs will be put off by this.

The call quality was pretty clear and signal reception good. Audio delivered by the bundled in-earphones is satisfactory. Better ones can be connected to the 3.5mm

headphone jack. The phone also plays back DivX and XviD files. We transferred some standard resolution AVI files without any downscaling and they played flawlessly. The video quality is also quite nice; this phone can easily double up as a good portable video player. The loudspeaker is quite audible as well. The onboard camera takes pretty good snaps. Smile detection works as advertised. It can also record video at a DVD-like resolution. Recording high resolution video can be a problem as the file size for a minute of video is roughly 12 MB.

At Rs. 24,150, the Samsung Jet is priced a lot above our liking. At this price, one would get a phone with an advanced and highly configurable OS than the Jet's. The phone handles multimedia tasks rather well and we would have definitely recommended it if the price was closer to Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 17,000.

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Price: Rs. 24,150

Specifications

Network: Quad-band GSM, HSDPA at 3.6 Mbps

Screen: 3.1-inch (480 x 800 pixel AMOLED)

Processor: Qualcomm MSM6246 800Mhz

Memory: 2 GB internal, microSD card slot (up to 16GB)

OS: Samsung Proprietary OS

Connectivity: Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g, Bluetooth 2.1, HSDPA, A-GPS, USB 2.0

Camera: 5 mega-pixel auto-focus with LED flash, Video at 720x480 resolution @ 15 fps
Battery: 1100 mAh

Dimensions/Weight: 108.8 x 53.5 x 11.9 mm / 110 g

RATINGS

Features	8
Performance	7
Build Quality	6
Value for Money	6
Overall	7